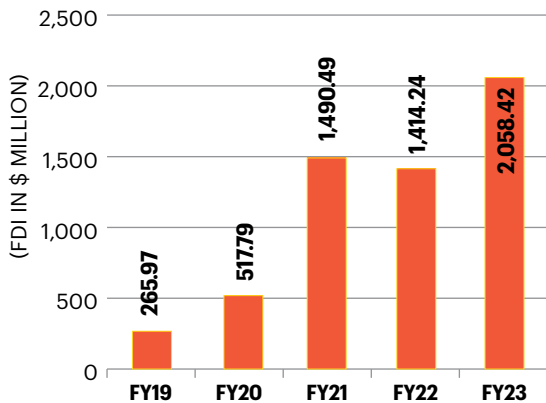
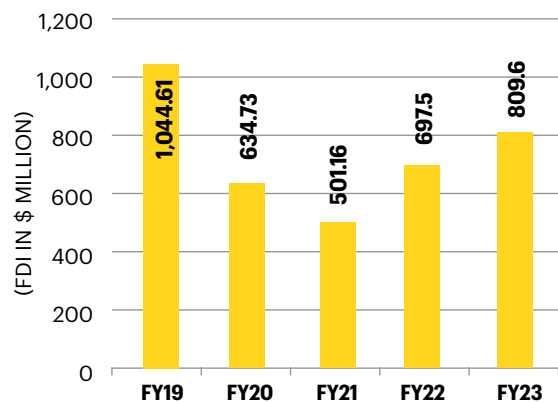


GROWING CONFIDENCE

Since FY19, FDI into India's pharma industry has expanded at a CAGR of 67 per cent...



...While FDI into the hospitals and diagnostics sector rebounded after a dip in FY21...



2020-21 and 1.3 per cent in 2019-20.

Lav Agarwal, Additional Secretary in the Union health ministry, says India is committed to the proposed priorities and pursuing a global consensus on flexible and coordinated global health architecture. "Integrating global initiatives for managing future health emergencies is essential for a more effective response and greater preparedness in the face of challenges," says Agarwal.

Agarwal, also the G20 Health Track Focal Point, says co-branded events and side events are being hosted for each Health Working Group meeting, looking at emerging aspects such as medical value travel, the impact of climate change on health, and the application and relevance of traditional medicine. He says that creating a global medical countermeasures coordination platform is also on the agenda. Agarwal says that India's initiatives, such as Co-WIN and Vaccine Maitri, have played a significant role in meeting global healthcare needs.

INFOTECH HAS THE CODE FOR GROWTH

The Aarogya Setu app and the associated Co-WIN platform for tracking the coronavirus vaccination

showed how digitalisation could revolutionise the healthcare setup. The Aarogya Setu app, introduced as a contact-tracing tool, became an online vaccination certificate for the Covid-19 vaccine. The app has been downloaded by over a billion people, and the government is now repurposing it for a broader healthcare role.

As the world's leading IT hub, India can promote innovation in using artificial intelligence (AI), apart from telemedicine and electronic health records, opening up new prospects for Indian tech firms and start-ups, claim healthcare industry experts. Similarly, by promoting digital technologies, telemedicine, electronic health records and health data interoperability, India is expected to drive advancements in healthcare delivery, patient care and disease management. This can open up opportunities for healthtech start-ups and businesses in India, say industry experts.

Sidharth Srinivasan, CEO of Lupin Digital Health, a subsidiary of pharma major Lupin Ltd, says the G20 presidency is a golden opportunity to make digital health a reality for all. "With its world-class healthcare profes-

